

KENTARO NAKAMURA

Contact: knakamura [at] g.harvard.edu

Website: <https://k-nakam.github.io>

EDUCATION

Harvard University

Ph.D. | *Public Policy* (Politics and Institution Track)

- Affiliation: Institute of Quantitative Social Science (IQSS)

Sep.2023 – Present

Cambridge, USA

University of Chicago

Master of Science | *Statistics*

Sep.2021 – Jun.2023

Chicago, USA

Waseda University

Bachelor of Arts | *Major: Political Science, Minor: Law, Certificate: Data Science*

- Best Paper Award (Excellent work at the Category of Mathematical and Statistical Measurement)

Apr.2017 – Sep.2021

Tokyo, Japan

George Washington University

Exchange Program

Aug.2019 – May.2020

Washington D.C., USA

RESEARCH INTEREST

Causal Inference with Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Political Communication, Political Violence

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Leveraging Generative Artificial Intelligence for Causal Inference with Unstructured Data

Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, with Kosuke Imai [\[URL\]](#)

- Proposed a new framework to use the internal representations of deep generative models for statistical inference

Causal Inference with Generative Artificial Intelligence: Application to Texts as Treatments

Journal of the American Statistical Association, with Kosuke Imai [\[URL\]](#)

- Developed new experimental designs to use texts created by deep generative model as a treatment

Understanding the Impact of Military Service on Support for Insurrection in the United States

Journal of Conflict Resolution, with Robert Pape, Keven Ruby, and Kyle Larson [\[URL\]](#)

- Analyzed why and how civilians with prior military experiences are prone to support political violence.

Balancing Opportunities and Incentives: How Rising China's Mediated Public Diplomacy Changes under Crisis

International Journal of Communication [\[URL\]](#)

- Estimated the strategic shift of the rising China's public diplomacy under crisis by machine learning

SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

Surrogate Representation Inference for Text and Image Annotations

Under Review [\[URL\]](#)

- Proposed a framework to improve efficiency with noisy and partially observed annotations
- Best poster award at the 2025 Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology.

Observational Equivalence of LLM and Human Annotation

Under Review, with Jing Ling Tan and George Yean [\[URL\]](#)

- Evaluated the quality of LLM annotations compared to human annotations.

GenAI Powered Dynamic Causal Inference with Unstructured Data

Under Review, with Kosuke Imai [\[URL\]](#)

- Proposed a framework to intervene the unstructured data at more granular level (e.g., sentences).

Where's the Evidence that Respondents Understand Your Survey Questions?

Working Paper, with Musashi Hinck, Gary King, and Brandon Stewart [\[URL\]](#)

- Proposed a framework and methodology to assess survey question understanding.

Causal Inference with Video Features as Treatments

Working Paper, with Adam Breuer, Michael H. Crespin, Bryce J. Dietrich, Kosuke Imai [\[URL\]](#)

- Proposed a framework for causal inference with video features as treatments.

INVITAED TALKS / PRESENTATIONS

Frontier in Political Methodology, Washington University in St. Louis (2026) [\[URL\]](#)

Stanford University, Guest Speaker for POLISCI 450D (2026)

Causal Inference Showcase, Harvard University (2026). [\[URL\]](#)

Nospare (Webinar for public audiences) (2025) [\[URL\]](#)

SOFTWARE

Debriefly [\[URL\]](#)

Survey Software for Automated Cognitive Debriefing

gpi-pack [\[URL\]](#)

Python module for Generative-AI Powered Inference.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant for Prof. Gary King

Harvard University

May.2024 – Present

Cambridge, USA

- Worked on the project of the automated cognitive debriefing (co-author)

Research Assistant for Prof. Matthew Baum

Shorenstein Center, Harvard Kennedy School

Nov.2023 – Present

Cambridge, USA

Data and Causal Inference Analyst

Chicago Projects on Security and Threats (CPOST), University of Chicago

Sep.2022 – Aug.2023

Chicago, USA

- Designed experiments, discussed identification strategies, and implemented causal mediation analysis

Research Assistant for Prof. Shuhei Kurizaki

Waseda University

May.2020 – Sep.2021

Tokyo, Japan

- Conducted the qualitative research on the foreign takeover in Europe (Co-Author since September 2020)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Fellow: GOV2003 (Statistical Models for Quantitative Social Science)

Harvard University

Spring 2026

Cambridge, USA

- Offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai

Teaching Fellow: GOV2002 (Causal Inference with Applications)

Harvard University

Fall 2025

Cambridge, USA

- Offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai

Teaching Assistant at the Center for Data Science

Waseda University

Sep.2020 – Mar.2021

Tokyo, Japan

- Checked class materials and answered the questions about Statistics and Machine Learning

HONORS AND AWARDS

Center for American Political Studies (CAPS) Seed Grant

Research Grant for Dissertation Research (USD1,000)

Apr.2026

Society of Political Methodology Best Poster Award

Best Method Poster presented by graduate students at PolMeth2025 (Emory) [\[News\]](#)

Jul.2025

The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Research Grant

Research Grant for Dissertation Research (USD2,000)

Apr.2025

The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Research Grant

Research Grant for the joint project with Jing Ling Tan and George Yang (USD2,000)

Apr.2025

Harvard Kennedy School Travel Grant Travel Grant for attending JSQPS2025 Winter Meeting (USD1000)	Jan.2025
The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Travel Grant Travel Grant for attending PolMeth2024 (USD500)	Jul.2024
Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship Merit-based scholarship. Partial tuition coverage (JPY 3 million yen) and monthly stipends.	Sep.2023 - Aug.2026
Graduate Council Research & Personal Development Fund, University of Chicago Travel Grant for attending SPSA2023 (USD600)	Jan. 2023
Tuition Fellowship, University of Chicago Equivalent to 25 percent of my approved tuition. Increased to 30% from 2nd year	Sep. 2021 - Jun. 2023
Statistics Consulting Cup Awards Best Prize in the Consulting Program at the Department of Statistics. [News]	Dec.2021
NSK Ltd. Scholarship Scholarship provided only for top four students in Japan. JPY13,600,000 $\approx$ USD100,000	Sep.2021 – Jun.2023
Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship Declined to accept NSK Scholarship. Merit-based scholarship.	Mar.2021
Best Paper Award (Category of Mathematical and Statistical Measurement) Thesis Competition of the Waseda Association for Political Science and Economics [News]	Feb.2021
Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship Merit based scholarship to support exchange program. JPY900,000. $\approx$ USD7,000	Aug.2019 – May.2020

ACADEMIC SERVICES / DISCUSSANT ROLES

Discussant: SPSA (2023), APSA (2025)
Reviewer: Political Analysis (2), International Studies Quarterly, Journal of Applied Econometrics
Others: Coordinator of Applied Statistics Workshop, Harvard University (2025-2026)

SKILLS

Languages: Japanese (Native), English (Fluent), Spanish (B1; Intermediate)
Programming: (Proficient) Python(3.X), R, C++ (Rcpp), $\LaTeX$, ArcGIS, STATA, HTML / (Experience) C, SQL

REFERENCES

Available upon request

Last updated on September 7, 2026